

The Toy Train Signal Station

Easy start · Either · Kid can lead · Ages 4–8 · 30 min

Brought to you by Corey — “Every toy is a character waiting for a story.”

Lay a route through the house or the yard, then invent the signs that keep every passenger safe.

WHAT YOU NEED

- Toy train, cars, or anything with wheels
- Paper and markers for signs
- Tape
- Books or blocks to build a bridge

BEFORE YOU START

Keep the route off stairs and away from doorways people walk through.

How to make it

- 1 Choose a start and a finish. Lay the route between them with tape, string, or track.
- 2 Walk the route slowly and look for three places that feel risky: a sharp turn, a narrow bridge, a crossing.
- 3 Make one sign for each risky spot. Draw the picture first, then add the word.
- 4 Build a signal station at the busiest point. It needs somewhere for a signaller to stand and something that changes: a flag, a flipping card, a paper arrow.
- 5 Run the train through once with all the signals set to stop. Then run it again with them set to go.
- 6 Give someone else the signal job and watch them run the route.

TALK ABOUT IT

Which of your signs would still make sense to someone who could not read the words?

TRY THIS TOO

Add a timetable. Give the train a departure time and see whether the signals can keep it running on schedule.

DID YOU KNOW? · PEOPLE & COMMUNITY

Signs and signals tell people what to do before they need to do it. A signal gives a driver time to slow down, wait, or turn. That is why they sit before the risky part of a journey rather than at it. Every crossing you have ever walked over works this way.